A device that remembers

IoT · Level 3 · Lesson 3



Today you will

- Decide how often a device should take readings for a job.
- Explain why every reading is a little wrong, and how averaging helps and costs.
- Plan a data log with times and units.

Read, store, trust

- Read faster than it changes
- Every reading wobbles a little
- Averaging: calmer, but later
- Time, unit and place on every row

Be a data logger

1. Choose what to measure, and where.
2. Draw a table: date, time, reading, unit, place.
3. Take a reading every hour for one day.
4. Draw a chart of the day.
5. Mark any reading that can't be right.

Keep the thermometer in the shade, never in direct sun. Never look straight at the sun when you measure shadows, and don't leave a phone in hot sun.

Let’s discuss

1. What could make your readings a little wrong?
2. When would one reading a day be enough, and when would it be far too few?
3. Why keep the raw data after you've cleaned it?

Check yourself

- Name a job that needs a reading every few seconds, and one that needs one a day.